

To connect **two laptops directly using Ethernet**, you would traditionally use an **Ethernet crossover cable**.

Why a crossover cable?

Both laptops are the **same type of device (host-to-host)**. Their Ethernet ports transmit (TX) and receive (RX) on the same wire pairs. A crossover cable swaps these pairs so that:

- **Laptop 1 TX → Laptop 2 RX**
- **Laptop 1 RX ← Laptop 2 TX**

This allows the two devices to communicate directly without needing a switch or hub.